also falls under the distributed peer-to-peer transaction model but is also useful in currency exchanges, with current support for numerous currencies. It is the second largest cryptocurrency with USD$ 2,036,364,833 market capitalisation.

The network maintains a publicly shared database that records all transactions and currency activity. Its decision making system is based on community consensus and takes up to 5 seconds to clear a transaction. Beyond its role as a transaction network Ripple also works with its own currency internally known as "ripples" or XRP. Its not a mandatory part of the network and treats all currencies alike for trading and transactional purposes.

Ripple is quickly catching up to Bitcoin in usage and may be the next generation of virtual currency protocols.

Ripple is made up of "gateways" that represent merchants willing to accept deposits from users which is then reflected as the holdings of users on the Ripple network. Unlike Bitcoin or Litecoin or any of the other digital currencies, Ripple does not rely on its currency as much as it does on its network protocol which is very similar to how normal banks operate. Except that the network of transaction is public as compared to a private setup by individual banks. All deposits and transactions are in public record which can be redeemed from "gateways" for fiat currencies. The system has an element of risk like those in normal banks where a bank can default on deposits made, similarly so can a gateway. The strength of the system is believed to